TAKE CHARGE OF YOUR TIME

by Ankur Warikoo

3 key Concepts

1) Time is an allocation
2) Time is energy
3) Time is money

① TIME IS AN ALLOCATION

→ Everyone has the same amt. of time

DON'T ASK – How much time do I have? ✗
instead, ASK – Where do I spend my time? ✓
↳ how do I allocate my time?

> Book recommendation — The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People by Stephan R. Covey

* Urgent – Important Framework (U-I Framework) of looking at Time

Acc. to this,

how you spend your time

urgency of the task you have to finish + importance of the task you have to finish.

U - I Matrix → P.T.O.

U-I Matrix

importance \ urgent	N	Y
Y	(N, Y) SCHEDULE IT	(Y, Y) DO IT RIGHT NOW
N	(N, N) DROP IT	(Y, N) LET SOMEONE ELSE DO IT FOR YOU

→ Problems

Questions / Thoughts.

Neither urgent nor imp. = Drop it → Guilty

Not urgent but imp. = Schedule it → is it necessary to schedule even if the work doesn't take a lot of time?

Soln

MY ADDITION TO THE U-I MATRIX [Adding a 3rd section to it]

importance \ urgent	N	Y
Y	(N, Y) SCHEDULE IT	(Y, Y) DO IT RIGHT NOW
N	(N, N) DROP IT	(Y, N) LET SOMEONE ELSE DO IT FOR YOU

time taken N/Y

ask yourself is it taking a lot of time?
Y – Yes, a lot of time
N – No, not a lot of time

cont.

Wan7.8

Possible cases –

urgent	important	lots of time taken	example
N	N	N	IG for 5 mins
N	N	Y	watching shows
N	Y	N	calling your parents
N	Y	Y	exercise / read
Y	N	N	calling a plumber
Y	N	Y	meetings/ online class :(
Y	Y	N	quick work call
Y	Y	Y	anything that needs your attention – crisis

- spend time on these 8 categories w/o feeling guilty
- important for us as humans
- NOTE: measure your time in each of these cases
  - → maintain an hourly log
  - → schedule everything
  - → understand where you're spending your time
    - ↓ this is important to understand because time is energy.

- Recording time would help you to know in which section of the matrix you spend most of your time.

- this will help you give time to things "you" consider important in your life because time is energy.

Wan7.8

- Your time allocation should NOT BE A GOAL BUT A RESULT OF A PROCESS

↓

You should give time to tasks not because you want to; it is a continuous process of trial where you keep measuring your time & ask yourself –

"DID I ACHIEVE , WHAT I WANTED TO ACHIEVE TODAY"

↓ if you felt happy, if you felt content at the end of the day

think about how your time allocation looked that day

⟹ Doing this process in a disciplined manner over a period of time, you find – TIME ALLOCATION THAT WORKS FOR YOU.

② TIME IS ENERGY

you don't have the energy to do something —it means→ you don't have the time

→ 4 Types of energy

(1) Physical energy – energy within your body from a physical perspective
- determined by the quality of sleep, food intake, fitness levels

(2) Emotional Energy – determined by how confident you are ; self control , empathy levels

(3) Mental Energy – do you speak +ve to yourself,
can you console yourself ,
do you look forward to do things

(4) Spiritual Energy – do you have integrity,
are you honest to yourself

→ these 4 energies make who you are
→ how you spend your time determines your energy levels

→ Your time management schedule doesn't matters ;
what matters is if you have the right energy to execute upon it, if you have set yourself for all the things you want to do.

↓

That is why it is important to –
Recognise that whether you're building or sucking up your energy.

determined by how you spend your time
Your task – optimising your energy levels around the most important things you want to achieve during the day.

When you're high on energy → schedule the most imp. tasks then
when your energy is the lowest → not urgent, unimportant tasks

→ When you think of time as energy

↓

you realize & pay attention to how you allocate your time

↓

aligning your tasks with your energy levels determines how much you achieve in a day.

↓

automatically determines your next cycle of energy levels & tasks you allocate time to.

↓

gets you to achieve what matters & is imp. to you.

③ TIME AS MONEY

→ time is valuable ; money is often used to measure it
→ gone time doesn't come back

eg.) ₹50,000 / month ; you work 22 days × 8 hrs each day

⇒ hourly rate = ₹285 / hr

It is important because of 2 reasons –

① Opportunity cost

cost of giving up one opportunity for doing another task.

→ every single moment you spend away from what you could do to inc. the value of your time you essentially dec. the value of your time.

② Actual Cost

cost from time spend from doing a task that can be done with the help of automatic tools.

Wan?. 8

→ successful people don't spend time doing things that are not worth their time.

→ time is valuable – it's not just money

↓

when you realize this – you start to carefully spend your time

→ It is imp. to constantly increase the value of your time.

→ recognize that value is attached to your time & your job is to keep increasing it's value as you grow.

SUMMARY

→ important concepts –

(1) time is an allocation

(2) time is energy

(3) time is money

→ time is not unlimited ; it is the only thing that you can never get back. It decreases rapidly.

→ start thinking about time in months or years ; & not in mins, seconds.

→ take control of your time, don't let external factors take it away from you.